

MIS 4723-001 Information Security | Spring 2026

Logistics

Instructor

Professor Luke Harris, Adams Hall 3233

Office Hours:

Email: jonlukeharris@ou.edu

Class Information

Location: Adams Hall 3210

Day/Time: Monday / Wednesday / Friday 1:00 – 1:50 PM

Final Exam: 5/14/26 8:00 – 10:00 AM Adams Hall 3210

Required Text

- Whitman, Michael and Herbert Mattord. *Principles of Information Security*, 7th ed. Cengage. 2022. ISBN: 9780357506493. MindTap access required for e-book and assignments. Purchase through the OU bookstore at <https://ou.textbookbrokers.com>.

Required Software

Productivity Tools (one of the following). These tools will be used for written assignments, lab submissions, and presentations

- Office 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
- Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Slides)
- Apple Productivity (Pages, Numbers, Keynote)

Virtualization & Lab Environment (one of the following). This course utilizes virtual machines for hands-on security labs. Students must install a supported hypervisor on their personal computer. Students must be able to run at least one Linux VM and one Window VM during the semester. Instructions and images will be provided.

- VMware Workstation (Windows)
- VMware Fusion (Mac)
- VirtualBox (Windows/Mac/Linux)
- Parallels (Mac, especially for Apple Silicon)
- UTM (Mac, free, Apple Silicon compatible)
- Hyper-V (Windows Pro/Enterprise editions only)

Linux Command-Line Environment only (Optional but recommended)

Windows:

- WSL2 (Windows Subsystem for Linux 2) with Ubuntu, Kali, or Parrot

Mac:

- macOS Terminal (zsh/Bash)
- Homebrew for package installation

Additional Security Tools. These will be downloaded during labs – no need to pre-install.

- Kali Linux or Parrot Security VM image
- Wireshark

- Nmap
- Hashcat
- Miscellaneous tools for incident response and log analysis
- Others as necessary will be downloaded when needed

Technical Requirements

You need a laptop and a wireless Internet connection in class. Given the nature of this course, you should bring a well-functioning laptop to each class. Additionally, we will spend time in virtualized environments so we will bounce back and forth among various operating systems. Opt for the most RAM that you can get if you have yet to obtain your laptop.

Recommended Professional Development (Optional)

Students are encouraged (but not required) and will be coached to participate in the National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 season during the semester. NCL provides hands-on CTF-style challenges that directly reinforce skills from the course, including: network traffic analysis, password cracking, OSINT, web exploitation, log analysis, cryptography, and incident response fundamentals. Participation can strengthen resumes and provide competitive experience but will not affect the course grade. Participation cost \$45 and includes season long cyber gym access, practice game, individual competition, and a team competition experience. Class teams will be formed from the participants. Information at <https://www.cyberskyline.com>.

Course Prerequisites

- MIS 3013 Introduction to Programming (grade of C or better)

Course Description

This course examines how organizations protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of their information assets. Emphasizing both managerial and technical aspects, students learn to identify, classify, and defend against security threats using contemporary frameworks and tools. Topics include data valuation, access control, cryptography, and incident response. Hands-on labs using Linux OS environments provide experiential learning opportunities that strengthen conceptual understanding. The course equips students to apply information security principles to real-world business problems.

Class Learning Outcomes (CLOs)

By successfully completing this course, you will be able to:

1. Explain the foundational principles, history, and legal-ethical context of information security, and differentiate among major types of business-critical data and cyber threats.
2. Develop and apply information-security governance frameworks, policies, and risk-management processes to protect organizational assets.
3. Configure and evaluate security architectures and technical controls including access management, firewalls, VPNs, intrusion detection, and cryptography using hands-on lab environments.
4. Design and assess incident-response, disaster-recovery, and business-continuity strategies that enhance operational resilience and organizational preparedness.
5. Analyze and communicate findings from real-world data-breach cases to evaluate control effectiveness and recommend improvements in security posture.

Expectations

Professor's Expectations of Students

As a student in MIS 4723, you are expected to:

1. Attend and Engage

- Arrive on time, prepared, and ready to participate in discussions, labs, and activities.
- Bring your laptop to every class.

2. Complete All Assigned Work

- Submit assignments, labs, quizzes, and exams on time.
- Follow all formatting, documentation, and submission guidelines.
- Begin assignments early enough to ask questions before the due date.

3. Uphold Academic Integrity

- Produce your own work on quizzes, assignments, and exams.
- Give proper credit for any sources used, including usage of AI.
- Avoid plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, and use of tools in prohibited ways

4. Communicate Professionally

- Use respectful, appropriate communication in class and online.
- Ask questions when concepts are unclear.
- Notify the instructor promptly about issues affecting your ability to meet deadlines.

5. Maintain a Functional Technical Environment

- Keep required software installed and updated.
- Ensure your VM environment is working before labs and exams.
- Troubleshoot basic issues and seek help early if problems arise.

Student Expectations of the Professor

As your instructor, I commit to:

1. Provide Clear Instruction and Structure

- Explain course concepts in a practical, accessible way.
- Provide all materials, instructions, and rubrics needed for success.
- Maintain an organized Canvas course with clear deadlines.

2. Support Your Learning

- Offer timely help during office hours, by appointment, and via email.
- Encourage a growth mindset – your skills will improve through practice.
- Connect course content to real-world cybersecurity experience.

3. Give Prompt and Fair Feedback

- Grade assignments in a reasonable timeframe.
- Provide clear, constructive feedback designed to help you improve.
- Apply grading criteria consistently and transparently.

4. Cultivate a Respectful and Inclusive Environment

- Treat all students fairly and with respect.
- Create a classroom culture that supports questions, curiosity, and professional conduct.
- Uphold OU policies on accessibility, inclusion, and conduct.

5. Keep Course Content Current and Relevant

- Integrate industry standards (NIST, MITRE ATT&CK, NICE Framework).
- Incorporate hands-on labs and real-world security scenarios.
- Update materials to reflect current trends, threats, and technologies.

Ethics and Professional Conduct in Cybersecurity Labs

This course includes hands-on exercises using security tools such as network scanners, password-cracking utilities, traffic analyzers, and other offensive/defensive techniques. These activities are strictly controlled, and all students must adhere to the following guidelines:

1. Authorized Use Only

All cybersecurity exercises must be conducted only in approved lab environments provided by the course (virtual machines, sandbox environments, isolated networks). Any unauthorized use violates federal and state law (CFAA), OU policy, and course standards. Students are not permitted to test or use these tools on:

- OU networks
- Personal devices belonging to others

- Home networks without explicit permission
- Any external system

2. Respect, Integrity, and Responsibility

Students must:

- Use cybersecurity tools solely for learning and professional development
- Treat all data with confidentiality and care
- Report accidental misuse immediately to the instructor
- Maintain professionalism in all lab work and online interactions

3. Academic and Legal Compliance

Ethical violations in cybersecurity can result in course failure, conduct review, or legal consequences.

Students must comply with:

- OU's Student Code of Conduct
- FERPA and data-handling guidelines
- Federal and state cybercrime laws
- Industry ethical standards (NICE, ISC² Code of Ethics, EC-Council Code of Ethics)

4. Purpose of These Exercises

Our goal is to build defensive and analytical skills, not to teach or encourage unauthorized system access. Security skills must always be used to protect, not harm. Students will learn:

- How attackers think
- How vulnerabilities are exploited
- How to secure systems responsibly

Learning Activities, Assignments, and Assessments

Grading and Evaluation Criteria

Grading will be based on a standard scale: (A=90-100, B=80-89, C=70-79, D=60-69, F=<60).

Performance in this course will be evaluated in 5 areas:

- Labs & Homework
- MindTap by Cengage chapter Quizzes
- Module Quizzes in Canvas (2)
- Group Presentations (2)
- In-Class Exams (Midterm and Final)

These components will be weighted according to the following table:

Activity	% of Grade
Participation & Attendance	5%
Labs & Homework	10%
MindTap by Cengage chapter Quizzes	15%
Module Quizzes (2)	15%
Midterm Exam	15%
Group Presentations (2)	20%
Final Exam	20%
<i>Total</i>	100%

Participation & Attendance (5%)

This course is designed around active, hands-on engagement. To earn participation credit, students must:

- Attend class regularly and arrive prepared
- Complete the in-class participation exercises assigned for that day

- Contribute to discussions, labs, and problem-solving activities

Participation exercises must be submitted during class. These activities are graded for **completion—not accuracy**. It is perfectly acceptable to be wrong during discussion; class time is where mistakes get corrected before they become exam errors.

Labs & Homework (10%)

The labs provide practical, hands-on experience with real security tools, virtualization, network scanning, and incident-response analysis. All labs and homework assignments must be completed individually, although students may collaborate to discuss general concepts.

These assignments will be completed outside of class and submitted via Canvas by the due posted due date indicated (usually by 11:59pm on Sunday of week due). Lab and homework submissions are evaluated based on reasonable effort, completeness, accuracy, and clarity of documentation. Additional labs may be assigned as needed to reinforce course concepts.

MindTap Chapter Quizzes (15%)

MindTap quizzes correspond to assigned textbook readings only and are intended to help students come to class prepared. These small quizzes will be taken through the MindTap course link and are open-book, open-note.

Module Quizzes (15%)

At the end of Module 1 and Module 3 there will be a module quiz taken online through Canvas covering all the material from that module. These will be 10-15 question quizzes that cover the key concepts from the lectures, labs, discussions, and readings designed to reinforce mastery of foundational security concepts. They are to be taken individually and will be open-book, open-note, but will be timed so time management may be key. Module quizzes prepare students for the midterm and final exams by focusing on practical application and conceptual understanding.

Midterm Exam (15%)

The midterm exam covers material from the first half of the course, including lectures, readings, in-class labs, and quizzes. The exam will consist of short-answer questions, applied security scenarios, problem-solving exercises similar to lab work. The goal is to assess foundational understanding of information security principles. These exams will be taken in-class during the regular scheduled meeting time.

Group Presentations (20%)

Two key skills that will set you apart in your future career in any IT/IS field are collaboration and communication. To build these skills you will work in a group throughout the semester to prepare 2 group project presentations. You will be assigned to a team to research the threat landscape and a historical breach and then deliver a 15-minute class presentation and submit an accompanying written report through Canvas. These assignments emphasize research quality, technical depth, clarity of communication, and the ability to connect real-world incidents or threat landscapes to course concepts. A detailed rubric will be provided in Canvas.

Final Exam (20%)

The final exam will mostly consist of material from the 2nd half of the course (although some first half material may bleed over). It emphasizes application of concepts, critical thinking, and integration of frameworks such as NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK, and core defensive strategies. This exam will be taken in-class during our schedule meeting time of finals week. This will be a 50 question exam taken through Canvas.

Dead Week CTF (0%)

Part of learning cybersecurity is understanding the tactics, techniques, and procedures of threat actors. Cybersecurity professionals often sharpen their skills using Capture-the-Flag competitions. During Dead Week we will hold a class CTF where you will have the opportunity to hack your way to some bonus points. It will be optional and will not negatively impact your grade in any way but it will be there for you to grab some points.

Course Policies

Late Policy

Assignments or other deliverables may be submitted anytime up to and including the date due. If your work is not submitted on time, the instructor reserves the option to deduct a percentage of the grade value for tardiness, depending upon the circumstances and appropriate communication between the student and the instructor. Late work will be accepted up to 7 days after the due date with an automatic 3% deduction per day. Submissions are not accepted after the 7-day late window. Here is a visual of the consequences of late work given a score of 100%:

- On-Time Submission = Max grade 100%
- 1 day late = 3% deduction; max grade 97%
- 2 days late = 6% deduction; max grade 94%
- 3 days late = 9% deduction; max grade 91%
- 4 days late = 12% deduction; max grade 88%
- 5 days late = 15% deduction; max grade 85%
- 6 days late = 18% deduction; max grade 82%
- 7 days late = 21% deduction; max grade 79%
- 8+ days late = not accepted

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

The University of Oklahoma has an Academic Misconduct Code that governs student academic performance in and out of the classroom. The Academic Misconduct Code can be reviewed online at <http://www.ou.edu/integrity>

Academic misconduct is defined as "any act that improperly affects the evaluation of a student's academic performance or achievement". All work assigned in this course is to be completed individually (unless otherwise stated). The steps and procedures as outlined in the Academic Misconduct Code will be followed in all cases of academic misconduct in this class.

MIS Division's Guidelines provides the following guidelines for dealing with Academic Misconduct:

1. All academic misconduct will be reported using the following form: <http://www.ou.edu/content/dam/integrity/docs/academic-misconduct-report.pdf>. Please read this form carefully so that you understand the potential penalties.
2. The instructor will decide whether the misconduct is an Admonition or Violation of the Academic Integrity Code.
3. When an instance of academic misconduct occurs on labs or similar assignments and the instructor categorizes this as Admonition, a grade of zero will be recorded and a deduction equal to the value of the assignment will be applied.
4. When an instance of academic misconduct occurs on an exam assignment and the instructor categorizes this as Admonition, a grade of zero will be recorded.
5. When an instance of academic misconduct occurs on an exam assignment and the instructor categorizes this as Violation of the Academic Integrity Code, no grade penalty shall be imposed until the student is officially found responsible for violating the Academic Integrity Code. Until this occurs, and "N" shall be filed as the student's final course grade. If established, a violation results in grade penalty and a University penalty.

6. Faculty may choose to impose greater grade penalties than those recommended above by the MIS Division.

Score/Grade Appeals

If you believe that the grading of an exam or any other material contains mistakes, talk with your instructor as soon as possible. Turn in the work in question to your instructor with a note explaining why you should get credit for the material you turned in. Any grade appeal must be turned in to your instructor not more than one week after the exam or graded material is returned to you. Otherwise, the appeal will not be considered. Note that grade or score changes are at the discretion of the instructor. It is important to understand that your grade or score may go up or down based upon a complete review of the work in question.

Incomplete Grades Policy

A grade of Incomplete may be awarded to students who have a legitimate reason for needing additional time to complete a course. Legitimate reasons include emergencies or extenuating circumstances that prevent a student from completing the course requirements within the normal time frame. Students must initiate the request for an incomplete prior to the end of the semester and must be in good standing in the course. In no case will a grade of incomplete be awarded to someone seeking more time to master the course material to improve their grade.

Generative AI Policy

I permit the use of standalone Generative AI tools like ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, etc., for the following:

- Searching for publications on your research topic.
- Creating an outline, text, or speech for presentations and writeups.
- Providing grammatical feedback on drafts.
- Further study on concepts outside of the class.
- Troubleshooting problems with software.
- Creating initial ideas for project.

When you use Generative AI for any of these, you are required to make a declaration acknowledging how and to what extent you used it. Please include an appendix that details the prompts you used and the responses you obtained. Usage of Generative AI outside of the clearly defined scope, and without acknowledgment as required, will be considered a violation of the academic integrity policy for this course.

Laptop Policy

All students majoring or minoring in MIS are expected to have a laptop computer that meets the minimum hardware and software criteria established by the MIS faculty. Recommended minimum laptop specifications for 2025-2026:

Hardware	Software
Processor: Intel Core i5 (12 th gen or newer) / AMD Ryzen 5 (5000 series or newer) / Apple M1 or M2 equivalent	Operating System: Windows 11 (or higher) / macOS Ventura (or higher)
Memory (RAM): Minimum 16 GB	Productivity Suite: Microsoft Office 365 (student license provided by OU)
Storage: 512 GB SSD or higher	Database Tools: SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS) for Windows; Azure Data Studio for macOS/Linux users
Wireless: Wi-Fi 6 (802.11ax) recommended; Wi-Fi 5 (802.11ac) acceptable	Browsers: Latest versions of Chrome
Ports: At least 2 USB ports	Antivirus (Windows Defender/McAfee free version)

Screen Size: 13” or larger recommended for productivity (1080p resolution minimum)	
Battery Life: At least 6 hours of use on a single charge recommended	

We recommend that students purchase a PC/Windows laptop computer. The OU IT Store carries several models that meet or exceed the minimum requirements specified above. Retail stores and online outlets also carry computers that meet these standards.

In addition, Price College and the Library have Dell Laptops that you can borrow from the kiosks for class time and homework assignments.

Can I use a Mac?

Yes – but you should be aware of several important limitations:

- Not all required business software is compatible with macOS.
- Some courses require SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS), which runs only on Windows. Mac users often need to install additional software (such as Parallels, or a virtual machine) to run Windows applications, which requires at least 125 GB of free storage.
- Differences in keyboard layout, shortcuts, and function displays can create additional challenges.
- Our experience shows that even with these workarounds, Mac users sometimes experience issues running required software.
- Only some faculty and staff can provide technical support for Mac-related issues.

If you choose to purchase a Mac, we recommend the MacBook Pro as the only model that has so far run without major problems. However, we cannot guarantee compatibility.

Can I use a Tablet?

- Microsoft Surface Pro 7 (meeting the minimum laptop specifications) is compatible with required programs and may be used.
- iPad Pro and other iPads are not recommended due to compatibility issues with required business software.
- While tablets are convenient, the lack of a full keyboard and limited compatibility make them less effective for technology-intensive courses.

Registration and Withdrawal

If you choose to withdraw from this course, you must complete the appropriate University form and turn the form in before the deadline. If you stop attending the course and doing the coursework without doing the required paperwork, your grade will be calculated with missed homework and examination grades entered as zero. This could result in receiving a grade of F in the course. Deadlines are shown in the [Academic Calendar](#), which is available from the Office of the Registrar.

University Policies

Mental Health Support

Support is available for any student experiencing mental health issues that are impacting their academic success. Students can either be seen at the University Counseling Center (UCC) located on the second floor of Goddard Health Center or receive 24/7/365 crisis support from a licensed mental health provider through [TimelyCare](#). To schedule an appointment or receive more information about mental health resources at OU please call the UCC at 405-325-2911 or visit [University Counseling Center](#). The UCC is located at 620 Elm Ave., Room 201, Norman, OK 73019.

Title IX Resources and Reporting Requirement

The University of Oklahoma faculty are committed to creating a safe learning environment for all members of our community, free from sex-based discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking, in accordance with Title IX. There are resources available to those impacted, including: speaking with someone confidentially about your options, medical attention, counseling, reporting, academic support, and safety plans. If you have (or someone you know has) experienced any form of sex-based discrimination or violence and wish to speak with someone confidentially, please contact [OU Advocates](#) (available 24/7 at 405-615-0013) or [University Counseling Center](#) (M-F 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. at 405-325-2911).

Because the University of Oklahoma is committed to the safety of you and other students, and because of our Title IX obligations, I, as well as other faculty, Graduate Assistants, and Teaching Assistants, are mandatory reporters. This means that we are obligated to report sex-based violence that has been disclosed to us to the Institutional Equity Office. This means that we are obligated to report sex-based violence that has been disclosed to us to the Institutional Equity Office. This includes disclosures that occur in: class discussion, writing assignments, discussion boards, emails and during Student/Office Hours. You may also choose to report directly to the Institutional Equity Office. After a report is filed, the Title IX Coordinator will reach out to provide resources, support, and information and the reported information will remain private. For more information regarding the University's Title IX Grievance procedures, reporting, or support measures, please visit [Institutional Equity Office](#) at 405-325-3546.

Reasonable Accommodation Policy

The University of Oklahoma (OU) is committed to the goal of achieving equal educational opportunity and full educational participation for students with disabilities. If you have already established reasonable accommodations with the Accessibility and Disability Resource Center (ADRC), please log into iAdvise to request your semester accommodations as soon as possible and contact me privately, so that we have adequate time to arrange your approved academic accommodations.

If you have not yet established services through ADRC, but have a documented disability and require accommodations, please complete [ADRC's pre-registration form](#) to begin the registration process. ADRC facilitates the interactive process that establishes reasonable accommodations for students at OU. For more information on ADRC registration procedures, please review their [website](#). You may also contact them at (405)325-3852 or adrc@ou.edu, or visit www.ou.edu/adrc for more information.

Note: disabilities may include, but are not limited to, mental health, chronic health, physical, vision, hearing, learning and attention disabilities, pregnancy-related. ADRC can also support students experiencing temporary medical conditions.

Religious Observance

It is the policy of the University to excuse the absences of students that result from religious observances and to reschedule examinations and additional required classwork that may fall on religious holidays, without penalty.

[\[See Faculty Handbook 3.15.2\]](#)

Adjustments for Pregnancy and Related Issues

Should you need modifications or adjustments to your course requirements because of pregnancy or a pregnancy-related condition, please request modifications via the [Institutional Equity Office website](#) or call the Institutional Equity Office at 405/325-3546 as soon as possible. Also, see the Institutional Equity Office [FAQ on Pregnant and Parenting Students' Rights](#) for answers to commonly asked questions.

Final Exam Preparation Period

Pre-finals week will be defined as the seven calendar days before the first day of finals. Faculty may cover new course material throughout this week. For specific provisions of the policy please refer to OU's [Final Exam Preparation Period policy](#).

Emergency Protocol

During an emergency, there are official university [procedures](#) that will maximize your safety.

Severe Weather: If you receive an OU Alert to seek refuge or hear a tornado siren that signals severe weather.

1. Look for severe weather refuge location maps located inside most OU buildings near the entrances.
2. Seek refuge inside a building. Do not leave one building to seek shelter in another building that you deem safer. If outside, get into the nearest building.
3. Go to the building's severe weather refuge location. If you do not know where that is, go to the lowest level possible and seek refuge in an innermost room. Avoid outside doors and windows.
4. Get in, Get Down, Cover Up
5. Wait for official notice to resume normal activities. Additional Weather Safety Information is available through the Department of Campus Safety.

The University of Oklahoma Active Threat Guidance

The University of Oklahoma embraces a Run, Hide, Fight strategy for active threats on campus. This strategy is well known, widely accepted, and proven to save lives. To receive emergency campus alerts, be sure to update your contact information and preferences in the account settings section at one.ou.edu.

RUN: Running away from the threat is usually the best option. If it is safe to run, run as far away from the threat as possible. Call 911 when you are in a safe location and let them know from which OU campus you're calling from and location of active threat.

HIDE: If running is not practical, the next best option is to hide. Lock and barricade all doors; turn off all lights; turn down your phone's volume; search for improvised weapons; hide behind solid objects and walls; and hide yourself completely and stay quiet. Remain in place until law enforcement arrives. Be patient and remain hidden.

FIGHT: If you are unable to run or hide, the last best option is to fight. Have one or more improvised weapons with you and be prepared to attack. Attack them when they are least expecting it and hit them where it hurts most: the face (specifically eyes, nose, and ears), the throat, the diaphragm (solar plexus), and the groin.

Please save OUPD's contact information in your phone.

NORMAN campus: *For non-emergencies call (405) 325-1717. For emergencies call (405) 325-1911 or dial 911.*

TULSA campus: *For non-emergencies call (918) 660-3900. For emergencies call (918) 660-3333 or dial 911.*

Fire Alarm/General Emergency:

If you receive an OU Alert that there is danger inside or near the building, or the fire alarm inside the building activates:

1. *LEAVE* the building. Do not use the elevators.
2. *KNOW* at least two building exits
3. *ASSIST* those that may need help
4. *PROCEED* to the emergency assembly area
5. *ONCE* safely outside, *NOTIFY* first responders of anyone that may still be inside building due to mobility issues.

6. *WAIT* for official notice before attempting to re-enter the building.

[OU Fire Safety on Campus](#)

Office of Access and Opportunity's Belonging Statement

Why You Belong at the University of Oklahoma: The University of Oklahoma fosters an inclusive culture of respect and civility, belonging, and access, which are essential to our collective pursuit of excellence and our determination to change lives. The unique talents, perspectives, and experiences of our community enrich the learning, and working environment at OU, inspiring us to harness our innovation, creativity, and collaboration for the advancement of people everywhere.

Course Reflection Survey

You'll receive a Course Reflection Survey at the end of each semester for each course that you are enrolled in. I strongly encourage you to complete this survey. Your feedback can help me adjust my class for future semesters to help other students be successful. Your feedback is confidential and I will only receive it after final grades are due. Course Reflection Survey results may also factor into teaching evaluations and annual performance reviews and are shared with department and program chairs.

Copyright Statement, for in-person or online courses

Sessions of this course may be recorded or live-streamed. These recordings are the intellectual property of the individual faculty member and may not be shared or reproduced without the explicit, written consent of the faculty member. In addition, privacy rights of others such as students, guest lecturers, and providers of copyrighted material displayed in the recording may be of concern. Students may not share any course recordings with individuals not enrolled in the class or upload them to any other online environment.

The Course Schedule (presented on the next page) should be considered tentative; adjustments to this schedule may be made. In-class, emailed, or Canvas-posted announcements supersede this outline.

Course Calendar Spring 2026 | January 20 – May 8

WK	Monday	Wednesday	Friday
1	MLK Jr. Holiday	<i>Course Syllabus and Overview</i> Text: Chapter 1 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 1 (due 1/25) Threat Brief Group Proposal (1/25)	<i>Intro to Information Security</i>
2	<i>Need for InfoSec</i> Text: Chapter 2 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 2 (2/1) Lab 1 (2/1)	<i>Real-World Breaches</i> Assignment: Breach Headers (In-Class)	<i>Attack Surface Mapping</i> Assignment: Surface Map (IC)
3	<i>Legal, Ethical, Professional</i> Text: Chapter 6 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 6 (2/8) Module 1 Quiz (2/8)	<i>Privacy, Policies, Codes</i> Assignment: CFAAA Check (IC)	<i>Cyber Ethics / MI Review</i> Assignment: Cookie Tracking (IC)
4	<i>Threat Landscape</i> Threat Landscape Report (2/15) Group Presentations	<i>Threat Landscape</i> Group Presentations	<i>Threat Landscape</i> Group Presentations
5	<i>InfoSec Management</i> Text: Chapter 3 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 3 (2/22) Lab 2 (2/22)	<i>NIST CSF</i> Assignment: Policy Map (IC)	<i>Mapping Policies -> Controls</i> Assignment: Framework ID (IC)
6	<i>Risk Management</i> Text: Chapter 4 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 6 (3/1) Homework 1 (3/1)	<i>Measuring Risk</i> Assignment: ALE Calc (IC)	<i>STRIDE & ALE</i> Assignment: Threat Model (IC)
7	<i>Security & Personnel</i> Text: Chapter 7 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 7 (3/8) Lab 3 (3/8)	<i>Roles and Permissions</i> Assignment: RBAC Roles (IC)	<i>Mitigating Insider Risks</i> Assignment: Insider Flags (IC)
8	<i>CISO Perspective</i>	<i>Midterm Review</i>	Midterm Exam In-Class Midterm Exam
9	Spring Break		
10	<i>Access Control Models</i> Text: Chapter 8 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 8 (3/29) Breach Impact Proposal (3/29)	<i>Firewalls, Zero Trust</i> Assignment: Firewall Rules (IC)	<i>Firewall Rules & Tuning</i> Assignment: Perms Check (IC)
11	<i>IDS/IPS Basics</i> Text: Chapter 9 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 9 (4/5) Lab 4 (4/5)	<i>SIEM & Logs</i> Assignment: Packet ID (IC)	<i>Intrusion Detection</i> Assignment: Log Search (IC)
12	<i>Intro to Cryptography</i> Text: Chapter 10 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 10 (4/12) Module 3 Quiz (4/12)	<i>PKI & TLS</i> Assignment: Hach Check (IC)	<i>Encryption & Hashing</i> Assignment: Cert Inspection (IC)
13	<i>Breach Impact</i> Breach Impact Report (4/19) Group Presentations	<i>Breach Impact</i> Group Presentations	<i>Breach Impact</i> Group Presentations

14	<i>NIST 800-61</i> Text: Chapter 5 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 5 (4/26) Homework 2 (4/26)	<i>Digital Forensics</i> Assignment: IR Stages (IC)	<i>IR Logs & IOC Identify</i> Assignment: Hash Compare Forensics (IC)
15	<i>Secure SDLC</i> Text: Chapter 11 Assignment: MT Quiz Ch 11 (5/3)	<i>Change Management</i> Assignment: Change Impact (IC)	<i>Patch Analysis</i> Assignment: Patch Order (IC)
16	<i>Dead Week CTF Challenge</i> Text: Chapter 12	<i>Dead Week CTF Challenge</i>	<i>Dead Week CTF Challenge</i>
	<i>Final Exam 5/14/26 8:00 – 10:00 AM Adams Hall 3210</i>		